

MEQ PRACTICE QUESTIONS (CASE STUDIES)

MODIFIED ESSAY QUESTION 6

A 35-year-old female, Janine who works as a Career medical officer at the Emergency Department was referred to you by the general practitioner for an admission with five weeks' complaints of low mood, sleep problems and issues with concentration. The general practitioner stated two past episodes of depression which were treated with antidepressants (eight-nine months each time). He also noted that she recently had a complaint from a patient in the emergency department and had to take a week off. The director of ED called you to discuss her admission. He also tells you of the complaint made by a patient against the Career Medical Officer (CMO) of acting inappropriately.

a) List and explain ethical work issues.

MODIFIED ESSAY QUESTION 7

You are called to carry out a home visit at Mrs Smith's house who is 72 years of age. She presents mildly confused, irritable and unsteady on her feet. Her previous mini-mental state examination scored 21/30. She showed impaired attention, concentration, short-term memory, impaired clock-drawing, impaired visuospatial function and frontal lobe dysfunction. She is currently on atenolol, lithium, fluoxetine, and L-DOPA.

In one exam they added Tricyclic Antidepressant (TCA) instead of fluoxetine.

a) Outline the possible causes for her presentation

Mrs Smith is admitted to the Older Patients Mental Health Service Inpatient Unit.

b) What would be your advice to the registrar in prescribing of medications?

Her son is visiting from overseas and he wants her to make a will.

c) Outline your process of assessing testamentary capacity.

She wishes to make an EPA for property affairs.

d) Assessment of capacity for Enduring Power of Attorney (EPA)

MODIFIED ESSAY QUESTION 8

You have been referred a 6 yr old boy Sam, by the paediatrician for encopresis. Sam lives with his mother who is a single mother and is unemployed. The paediatrician has ruled out any organic issues and started him on laxatives and a star chart which has not worked.

a) Outline your assessment / outline your approach to assessment.

Sam has not seen his father for some time. His mother has depression and is on antidepressants. His mother said that she is tired of bribing him to behave. When you see Sam, you notice that he has a bruise on his arm.

b) Outline your management plan.

MODIFIED ESSAY QUESTION 9

A 4-year-old girl who lives with her parents and has two older siblings, aged 8 and 10, was admitted to the medical ward for investigation of her abdominal mass which turned out to be malignant on histology. Her father became irritable after being told the news, stopped sleeping and started responding to hallucinations and behaving bizarrely as per nursing staff. Currently, he is by daughter's bedside, agitated, verbally aggressive to the staff, not letting blood samples be collected. Nursing staff call you from the ward.

a) What information would you get from the treating team before seeing the patient?

b) Outline the possible causes for father's behaviour.

c) Outline the ethical and medical issues.